The Time-Travelling Omnivore

A genre-agnostic viewer whose ratings follow craft more than labels.

A CINEMATIC IDENTITY REPORT FOR SYNTHETIC AUDIT (@SYNTHETIC-AUDIT) · BUILT FROM THE LETTERBOXD EXPORT OF 2026-09-01

I. The identity

The Time-Travelling Omnivore. The phrase is not a horoscope; it is distilled from 210 ratings and 74 reviews. Since 2023, Synthetic Audit has logged 240 diary entries across 240 films — roughly 502 hours in the dark.

In practice your average is 3.36★, which makes a 3★ a below-average grade: 43% of your films sit there or lower, and anything at 4★ is a genuine recommendation.

II. What actually moves you

Across your 13 main genres the shrunk averages span only 0.19★ (from Adventure at 3.22★ to Drama at 3.41★). You are a genre omnivore in the truest sense: the label on the box tells us little about how you will feel. Execution, scale and ambition separate your favourites from your shrugs.

Films recognised by a major awards body average 3.36★ (38 films) versus 3.35★ for everything else (161). The globally canonical films — covered by 60+ Wikipedias — average 3.38★. Consensus quality is a weak predictor for you — you trust your own response over the canon.

III. The five-star formula

Comparing your 60 films rated 4.5★+ with the 120 rated 3.5★ or less: pre-2000 release (68% vs 58%) are markedly more common at the top.

The 5★ shelf itself is small and specific: Amber Tide 01, Amber Tide 08, Amber Tide 15, Blue Horizons 03, Blue Horizons 17, Clouds in Reverse 02, Clouds in Reverse 09, Clouds in Reverse 16, Electric Rain 07, Electric Rain 14, Glass Orchard 03, Glass Orchard 10, Glass Orchard 17, Midnight Atlas 05, Midnight Atlas 12, Midnight Atlas 19, Quiet Signals 13, Silver Rooms 08, The Last Lantern 06, The Last Lantern 13, The Last Lantern 20, The Long Return 04, The Long Return 11, The Long Return 18, The Paper Moon 02, The Paper Moon 09, The Paper Moon 16, Velvet Orbit 05, Velvet Orbit 12 and Velvet Orbit 19. 3 of the 30 are animated, against 13% of everything you rate. 3 of them have been logged more than once; your favourites are films you go back to.

IV. Hidden patterns and contradictions

The Action films paradox. Action films sit below your average (3.30★ across 28 films), yet it contains some of your highest ratings — The Last Lantern 13, The Long Return 04, The Long Return 18, The Paper Moon 09 — alongside some of your lowest (The Last Lantern 01, The Last Lantern 15, The Long Return 06). Same label, opposite verdicts: you respond to how a film executes the genre, not to the genre itself.

22 of your films (10%) are Synthetic Sequence films, averaging 3.18★ (−0.15★ vs. your baseline). The exceptions — Amber Tide 01, The Long Return 11, Amber Tide 04 — show it isn't the label you dislike. High exposure with below-average returns usually means habit or event-viewing — the next instalment, the big opening weekend — rather than preference.

28 of your films (13%) are Animation films, averaging 3.20★ (−0.13★ vs. your baseline). The exceptions — Clouds in Reverse 02, Electric Rain 07, Velvet Orbit 12 — show it isn't the label you dislike. You return to this category often, but on average it returns less than the rest of your viewing. It may be habit, convenience or company rather than preference.

Of 18 films you've rated more than once in your diary, 0 went up on the later viewing, 18 held and 0 went down. Selection plays a role — you rewatch what you already liked — but the asymmetry is still telling: returning to a film tends to deepen your appreciation, while thinking about it from a distance tends to deflate early enthusiasm.

You usually agree with the Academy, which makes these stand out: Amber Tide 03 (2★), Amber Tide 05 (1.5★), Amber Tide 10 (2★), Amber Tide 17 (2★), Amber Tide 19 (1.5★), The Long Return 01 (1.5★), The Long Return 06 (2★), The Long Return 08 (1.5★), The Long Return 13 (2★), The Long Return 15 (1.5★), The Long Return 20 (2★). Acclaim did not rescue these for you. Look at what they share — they are the clearest map of your personal limits.

V. Representative films and filmmakers

Synthetic Director 4 is your most-watched director (19 films, 3.47★ average), but Synthetic Director 11 is your most rewarding (9 films, 3.56★). Synthetic Director 3 is your most uneven (9 films ranging widely, SD 1.36). Synthetic Director 3 consistently underperforms for you (3.11★ across 9).

The people you never think about predict your ratings: Synthetic Composer 0 (composer, 28 films, 5★); Synthetic Composer 1 (composer, 29 films, 4.5★); Synthetic Composer 2 (composer, 28 films, 4★). Composers and cinematographers recur across directors and franchises. When one of these names shows up in the credits of something new, it is a quiet vote of confidence.

If one shelf had to explain you to a stranger, it would hold Amber Tide 01, Electric Rain 07, The Paper Moon 02, Blue Horizons 17, Clouds in Reverse 09, The Long Return 18, Glass Orchard 17, Midnight Atlas 15, The Last Lantern 13 and Quiet Signals 13. Selected greedily: each pick maximises rating plus the number of new high-affinity traits (genres, people, eras, regions) it brings to the set.

VI. How the taste has moved

In 2023 you logged 78 viewings averaging 3.40★; in 2025, 79 averaging 3.40★. . New releases made up 4% of first watches in 2023 and 1% in 2025.

Year-to-year shifts in a few hundred films are noisy; treat these as direction-of-travel rather than firm conclusions.

VII. The unexplored map

Some territory is barely mapped: western (0 films), war (0 films) and music (0 films). With samples this small, the ratings there say almost nothing either way — they are open questions, not verdicts.

Only 62% of your films predate 2000 and 40% come from outside the English-speaking West.

Your 36-film watchlist is a different person's taste: median release year 1989 versus 1993 for what you actually watch. Horror: 15% of the watchlist vs 12% watched; Major-award recognised: 15% of the watchlist vs 17% watched; Not in English: 38% of the watchlist vs 40% watched. Half the list has been waiting 0.0+ years — Amber Tide 21 and Amber Tide 22 since 2026-09-01. The watchlist records aspiration — older — while your diary records what wins on a given night. The gap is where the most rewarding next discoveries are likely to be.

VIII. A closing reading

Put together, the evidence describes someone for whom cinema is an event.

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Your watchlist already knows where to go next — older. And on the evidence of your own ratings (older films +0.10★, world cinema +0.03★), going there is a better bet than habit suggests.

Ratings, dates and reviews come from your Letterboxd export (synthetic-audit-fixture.zip); film metadata from synthetic-fixture. Patterns describe your own history; none is a causal claim. Generated 2026-10-26.